3. Allotment of party tickets during elections and the formation of council of ministers in the states on caste lines.

4. Caste conflicts between higher and lower castes or between dominant castes in various states like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and so on.

5. Violent disputes and agitations over the reservation policy.

B.K. Nehru observed: "The communal electorates (of the British days) in a vestigal form still remain in the shape of reservations for the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. They serve to emphasise caste origin and make people conscious of the caste in which they were born. This is not conducive to national integration"[5].

At the state level, the politics is basically a fight between the major caste groups like Kamma versus Reddy in Andhra Pradesh, Lingayat versus Vokaligga in Karnataka, Nayar versus Ezhava in Kerala, Bania versus Patidar in Gujarat, Bhumiar versus Rajput in Bihar, Jat versus Ahir in Haryana, Jat versus Rajput in Uttar Pradesh, Kalita versus Ahom in Assam and so on.

4. Linguism

Linguism means love for one's language and language-speaking people. The phenomena of linguism, like that of regionalism, communalism or casteism, is also a consequence of political process. It has two dimensions: (a) the reorganisation of states on the basis of language; and (b) the determination of the official language of the Union.

The creation of the first linguistic state of Andhra out of the then Madras state in 1953 led to the countrywide demand for the reorganisation of states on the basis of language. Consequently, the states were reorganised on a large-scale in 1956 on the basis of the recommendations made by the States Reorganisation Commission[6] (1953–1955). Even after this, the political map of India underwent a continuous change due to the pressure of popular agitations and the political conditions, which resulted in the bifurcation of existing states like Bombay, Punjab, Assam, and so on.

The enactment of the Official Languages Act (1963) making Hindi as the Official Language of the Union led to the rise of anti-Hindi agitation in South India and West Bengal. Then, the Central government assured that English would continue as an 'associate' official language so long as the non-Hindi speaking states desire it. Moreover, the three-language formula (English, Hindi and a regional language) for school system is still not being implemented in Tamil Nadu[7]. Consequently, Hindi could not emerge as the *lingua franca* of the composite culture of India as desired by the framers of the Constitution.

The problem of linguism got accentuated with the rise of some regional parties like the TDP, AGP, Shiv Sena and so on.

NATIONAL INTEGRATION COUNCIL

In 1961, the central government convened the National Integration Conference to find ways and means to combat the evils of communalism, casteism, regionalism, linguism and narrow-mindedness and to formulate definite conclusions in order to give a lead to the country. This conference decided to set-up a National Integration Council (NIC) to review all matters pertaining to national integration and to make recommendations thereon. Accordingly, the NIC was constituted in 1961 and held its first meeting in 1962.